

NovaTech Solutions

Employee Handbook

Your Guide to Working at NovaTech Solutions

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Welcome to NovaTech Solutions

This handbook is your primary reference for understanding your rights, responsibilities, and the culture we uphold at NovaTech. Please read it carefully and retain it for future reference. Questions should be directed to your HR Business Partner.

1. About NovaTech Solutions

NovaTech Solutions was founded in 2011 and operates from seven offices across the UAE, UK, Singapore, and the United States. We employ over 1,200 professionals across software engineering, data science, consulting, and operations.

Our mission is to help enterprises accelerate digital transformation through intelligent software and data platforms. We are proud to be an equal-opportunity employer and committed to fostering an inclusive, respectful, and innovative workplace.

2. Working Hours & Attendance

Standard working hours at NovaTech are **8:30 AM to 5:30 PM, Sunday through Thursday** in GCC offices, and **9:00 AM to 6:00 PM, Monday through Friday** in UK/US offices. A one-hour unpaid lunch break is included.

Employees are expected to be punctual. Patterns of lateness exceeding 15 minutes more than three times per month will be flagged for a performance discussion with the line manager.

- Flexible start time of ± 1 hour is available with manager approval.
- Core hours (during which all team members must be available) are 10:00 AM – 3:00 PM.
- Time off in lieu (TOIL) must be approved in advance and used within 60 days.
- Overtime beyond 45 hours/week requires written approval from a Head of Department.

3. Remote Work Policy

NovaTech supports a hybrid working model. Employees in non-client-facing roles may work remotely up to **3 days per week** after completing 6 months of employment and receiving explicit approval from their line manager.

Remote work is a privilege, not a right. It may be revoked if performance benchmarks are not met or if the employee's role changes to require on-site presence.

- Fully remote arrangements (5 days/week) require Head of HR approval and are only granted for exceptional circumstances.
- Employees must be reachable and responsive during core hours regardless of work location.
- A suitable, private, and distraction-free workspace is required. Hot-desking from public cafés is discouraged for client calls.
- Company laptop, VPN connection, and MFA-enabled accounts are mandatory when working remotely.
- If your internet is unstable, you are expected to come into the office that day.

Note: Employees on probation (first 6 months) are not eligible for remote work without an exception approved by HR.

4. Code of Conduct

Every NovaTech employee is expected to act with integrity, professionalism, and respect at all times — whether in the office, on client premises, at company events, or on social media when representing the company.

Harassment, discrimination, bullying, or retaliation of any kind will not be tolerated and may result in immediate termination.

- Treat all colleagues, clients, and partners with dignity regardless of their role, background, or seniority.
- Do not share confidential company or client information externally or on social media.
- Avoid conflicts of interest; disclose any outside employment or business interests to HR.
- Do not accept gifts from vendors or clients valued above OMR 30 (or equivalent) without written HR approval.
- Report suspected misconduct through the anonymous Ethics Hotline at ethics@novatech.io.

5. Dress Code

NovaTech operates a **Smart Casual** dress code in its offices. On days with external client visits or executive presentations, **Business Formal** attire is expected.

- Acceptable smart casual: chinos, collared shirts, blouses, blazers, clean trainers.
- Not acceptable: ripped jeans, sleeveless tops, flip-flops, clothing with offensive graphics.
- Engineering teams may wear casual attire on Fridays (non-client days) — 'Casual Fridays' apply to GCC offices only.

6. Performance Management

NovaTech uses a **bi-annual review cycle**: mid-year check-in (July) and annual appraisal (December). Ratings are on a 5-point scale: Exceptional, Exceeds Expectations, Meets Expectations, Needs

Improvement, Unsatisfactory.

Compensation adjustments and promotions are tied to the December appraisal. Employees rated 'Needs Improvement' two cycles in a row will be placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan (PIP).

- Goals are set at the beginning of each year using the OKR framework.
- Employees can request an informal mid-cycle check-in with HR at any time.
- A 360-degree feedback module is used for all Senior Managers and above.

7. Probation & Termination

All new employees serve a **6-month probationary period**. During probation, either party may terminate employment with 2 weeks' written notice.

After probation, the notice period is **1 month** for individual contributors and **3 months** for Managers and above. Garden leave may be applied at NovaTech's discretion.